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Everyday Holiness

Week 4 · Virtue & the Predominant Fault

This is the week you look honestly at the one pattern that pulls you from God most -- and discover it is not your worst self, but the shadow of your greatest strength. There is no shame here. Only the freedom that comes from naming a thing so grace can heal it.

THE REFRAME THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

Your fault is the distortion of your greatest strength. God gave you a real gift; the fall bent it. Depth becomes Vanity or Sloth. Drive becomes Pride or Anger. Warmth becomes people-pleasing. Naming this is not self-hatred -- self-hatred has never made a saint. It is honest recognition, so you can turn toward the grace that heals instead of hiding.

+ *"Return to me with your whole heart." -- Joel 2:12*

THE SIX FAULTS & THEIR REMEDIES

FAULT	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE	THE VIRTUE
Pride	Must be first, right, in control. Hard to submit or admit fault.	***Humility***
Vanity	The ache to be seen, known, approved. Living for others' eyes.	***Simplicity***
Sensuality	The reach for comfort, ease, escape when depleted.	***Temperance***
Anger	Quick heat, sharp word, tightening grip. Often guards fear.	***Meekness***
Spiritual Sloth	Why bother. God feels far. Showing up will not matter.	***Fervor***
Envy	The ache at another's good. Comparison that steals joy.	***Gratitude***

Notice which one made your stomach drop as you read. That discomfort is information.

WEEK 4 *T -- Turning*

+ *"Create in me a clean heart, O God." -- Psalm 51:10*

Turning is the hinge of the whole model -- the half-second where you notice the old groove and choose a different path. It is an act of the will, not a feeling. You turn first; the feeling follows. This week you practice turning your fault toward God each time it appears.

MORNING REFLECTION · WEEK 4

Which fault, honestly, is yours -- the one you recognized as you read? Name it without softening it.

What is the good, God-given strength underneath it? What gift is your fault the distortion of?

Where did this fault show up this week -- with whom, and in what moment specifically?

"Your fault is not evidence something is wrong with you. It is the shadow of something beautiful."

THE REMEDY IS RECEIVED, NOT FORCED

You do not defeat a fault by white-knuckling the opposite. You receive the healing virtue in small, repeated practices. You do not try to care less about approval -- you do one small thing for God's eyes only, and the grip loosens over time. Character is built in ten thousand tiny elections, most of which no one will ever see.

What is the virtue that heals your fault? What would one small practice of it look like this week?

Where do you tend to fight your fault with shame instead of grace? What would grace do differently?

CONFESSION AS MEDICINE

Confession is a hospital, not a courtroom. A powerful practice: name your predominant fault by its root, not just a list of actions. 'Father, I struggle with vanity -- the need to be seen and approved of.' If Confession is hard or new for you, go gently. God is not tapping His foot at the door; He is the father running down the road to meet you.

Where are you with Confession right now? What would it mean to bring the root, not just the symptoms?

BRIDGE THOUGHT · WEEK 4

Hold your struggle and God's mercy in one breath. Name the fault honestly in the first half; let mercy have the second. Example: 'I reached for comfort again tonight -- and mercy is still available to me, and I can turn again tomorrow.' Write one you can say tonight without flinching.

THIS WEEK'S PRACTICE

Each day, one small practice of your healing virtue -- offered, not performed. And each time your fault appears, name it and turn: 'There it is. Lord, I turn toward You.' That is the whole work. Small, repeated, faithful.

VIRTUE PRACTICED · FAULT NAMED & TURNED	S	M	T	W	T	F	S

+ *"He who began a good work in you will bring it to completion." -- Philippians 1:6*